

Bruna Almeida Paroni

PhD Candidate in Communication Sciences and Digital Culture & Teaching Assistant

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Bio Brunas is a PhD Candidate in Communication Sciences and Digital Culture at the University of Urbino Carlo Bo (Italy). With a background in linguistics and communication studies, she studies how digital platforms and algorithmic amplification shape political communication, and how these dynamics unfold across borders. Her research combines computational methods with close attention to language and social context, working mainly across Brazilian and Italian cases. Her work has been published in international journals, presented at international conferences, and developed through research stays at the DMRC (Queensland University of Technology, Australia) and ZeMKI (University of Bremen, Germany). She now serves as a Teaching Assistant at Urbino for Internet Studies and for AI and Communication, at both undergraduate and graduate level. She has previously taught university courses in Portuguese and Italian, in both Italy and Brazil, and worked as a journalist and web writer for regional media in Italy. Her path into research began as an undergraduate at the University of São Paulo, where she conducted a research project in applied linguistics, on multilingualism and additional languages. She also holds a teacher-training degree focused on active learning methodologies.

EDUCATION

PhD in Humanities — Communication Sciences & Digital Culture 2023 – present

University of Urbino Carlo Bo, Italy · Dept. of Communication Sciences, Humanities & International Studies

Research area: algorithmic amplification, political disinformation, and destructive polarization on digital platforms (case studies: Brazil & Italy). Supervisor: Prof. Fabio Giglietto.

MA in Public, Digital & Business Communications — Digital media 2017 – 2020

University of Perugia, Italy — 110/110 e lode (summa cum laude, top 5%)

Thesis: Digital Populism — The Brazilian Case

Teaching Degree (Licentiate) 2012 – 2015

University of São Paulo, Brazil — Faculty of Education

BA in Linguistics, Literature & Modern Languages 2010 – 2015

University of São Paulo, Brazil — Faculty of Philosophy, Philology & Humanities

Coursework across pragmatics, semantics, syntax, and sociolinguistics.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Journal articles

- Marino, G., Paroni, B., & Giglietto, F. (2026). Measuring partisan community dynamics: a longitudinal analysis of affective engagement in pro-Bolsonaro Facebook networks. *Information, Communication & Society*, 1–20. doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2026.2696929
- Righetti, N., Kulichkina, A., Almeida Paroni, B., Cseri, Z. F., Aguirre, S. I., & Maikovska, K. (2025). Mainstreaming and transnationalization of anti-gender ideas through social media: the case of CitizenGO. *Information, Communication & Society*, 1–24. doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2025.2470229

Conference proceedings

- Paroni, B. (2026). Flooding the tropical zone: Understanding algorithmic amplification on Instagram during election campaigns [Extended abstract]. *#SMSociety 2026 Book of Abstracts: International Conference on Social Media & Society* (pp. 625–631). University of Glasgow. <https://socialmediaandsociety.org/2026/smsociety-2026-book-of-abstracts-pdf/>
- Choucair, T., Vodden, L., Kathirgamalingam, A., Esau, K., Bruns, A., Pressman, P., ... Paroni, B. (2026). Humans and Machines in the Loop: Rethinking LLMs for Conflict and Disagreement in Content Analysis of Social Complex Phenomena. *AoIR Selected Papers of Internet Research*. doi.org/10.5210/spir.v2024i0.15391
- Paroni, B., Marino, G., Giglietto, F., Choucair, T., O'Connor Farfan, K., Svegaard, S., ... Tavares, C. Q. (2026). Have Digital Media Platforms a Role in Fostering a Polarized Public Debate? Evidence from Latin America. *AoIR Selected Papers of Internet Research*. doi.org/10.5210/spir.v2024i0.15393
- Marino, G., Almeida Paroni, B., & Giglietto, F. (2024). The Brazilian Digital Battlefield: Investigating the Dynamics of Political Information Campaigns in Post-Bolsonaro Era. *AoIR Selected Papers of Internet Research*. doi.org/10.5210/spir.v2024i0.13999

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & INVITED TALKS

Presented

Social Media & Society International Conference — University of Glasgow, Scotland	2026
VIII Conference of the Italian Society of Sociology, Culture & Communication (SISCC) — University of Roma Tre, Italy	2026
26th AoIR Conference — Fluminense Federal University, Brazil (selected for Doctoral Colloquium)	2025
25th AoIR Conference — University of Sheffield, UK	2024
Italian Association of Political Communication (AssoComPol) — University of Catania, Italy	2024
IV Communication Conference: Communication & Democracy — University of Coimbra, Portugal (online)	2024

Invited & Guest seminars

GenAI and Political Communication: applying the LLMs-in-the-loop approach University of Urbino, Italy	2026
“Flooding the 'Tropical' Zone”: Algorithmic Amplification in Divisive Visual Narratives during Elections in Brazil University of Bremen, Germany	2026
LLM-in-the-Loop for Identifying Narratives in Partisan Spaces on Facebook in Brazil Federal University of Rio Grande do Sul, Brazil	2025
Amplified Reach: Symptoms of Destructive Polarization on Instagram during Elections Queensland University of Technology, Australia	2025

VISITING RESEARCH STAY

Digital Media Research Centre (DMRC) — Queensland University of Technology, Australia <i>Supervisors: Prof. Axel Bruns & Dr. Tariq Choucair. Fully funded by the University of Urbino.</i>	Jun – Sep 2025
Centre for Media, Communication & Information Research (ZeMKI) — University of Bremen, Germany <i>Supervisor: Prof. Cornelius Puschmann. Fully funded by the EU / Erasmus+ Traineeship.</i>	Apr 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant — University of Urbino Carlo Bo, Italy <i>Internet Studies (2024/25, 2025/26), AI and Communications (2025/26), Web Marketing Lab (2024/25), to Prof. Fabio Giglietto.</i>	2024 – present
Teaching Fellow in Portuguese & Brazilian Studies — University of Perugia, Italy <i>Delivered Brazilian Portuguese courses at the Department of Humanities and the University Language Centre (CLA): Bachelor's program in Foreign Languages & Cultures (2021–2022) and Master's program in Languages, Comparative Literature & Intercultural Translation (2022–2023).</i>	2021 – 2023
Teaching Fellow in Italian Studies — University of São Paulo, Brazil <i>“Italiano no Campus”, Department of Modern Languages.</i>	2015 – 2016

OTHER FELLOWSHIPS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Fully-funded Master's Scholarship — Umbrian Agency for University Studies, Italy	2017 – 2019
Scholarship — Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Italy	2016
Academic Exchange Scholarship — University of São Paulo, Brazil (exchange at University of Parma, Italy)	2014
Undergraduate Research Assistant — University of São Paulo, Brazil	2011-2012

RESEARCH GROUPS, SERVICE & ORGANIZING

Research group: MINE — Mapping Italian News Research Program, University of Urbino (2023 – present).	
Academic board: PhD Student Representative, Dept. of Communication Sciences & Doctoral School of Humanities (2024 – 2025).	
Organizing committee: International PhD Seminars (Urbino, 2024 & 2026); XLVI Convegno Internazionale di Americanistica (Perugia, 2024).	

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

European Communication Research & Education Association (ECREA), 2026– · Association of Internet Researchers (AoIR), 2024– · Diaspora Ricercatori, 2023– · Centro Studi Americanistici “Circolo Amerindiano”, 2023–

SELECTED ADVANCED TRAINING

Summer schools: Milan International Summer School of Political Communication (2024), University of Milan, Italy; IPSA–USP Summer School in Concepts, Methods & Techniques in Political Science (2024), University of São Paulo, Brazil.

Methods: R Programming Fundamentals (Stanford Online); training in social network analysis, LLM-in-the-loop content analysis, and coordinated-sharing detection.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Computational: R / RStudio (primary), network analysis, longitudinal / time-series analysis, LLM-based content analysis (API & chatbot), statistical modelling, Meta Content Library / Meta Research environment / Google Workspace, Office 365.

Organizational and Task Managers Tools: Notion, Slack, Trello.

Languages: Portuguese (native), Italian (C2), English (C1), French (A2), Spanish (A1).